

The 6:15

WEDNESDAY · SEPTEMBER 9, 2026

NO. 12

THE BOARD

CALENDAR · NEXT 10 DAYS

Overnight — [NEW]	IRGC ballistic missiles struck a hangar housing US RQ-4/MQ-9 drones at Prince Hassan Airbase, Jordan; Jordan's military says it intercepted 10 of 13 missiles, rest fell on open ground, no casualties reported; a US official called it "ineffective" (ABC News, 3:02a ET) [single-sourced, developing, not yet corroborated by CENTCOM]
Thu 9/10	Adobe (ADBE) reports fiscal Q3 after close — cons. adj. EPS ~\$6.08-6.09 on \$6.67-6.72B rev., five days after a CEO-succession shock cut the stock -6.5%. Oracle (ORCL) also reports fiscal Q1 FY27 after close — cons. EPS \$1.74/\$19.14B rev. Weekly jobless claims, 8:30a (prior wk 206k).
Fri 9/11	Aug. CPI, 8:30a (BLS) — cons. headline +0.3% m/m/2.9% y/y (from 2.7% in July), core +0.3% m/m/3.1% y/y. Last data point before the Fed's decision.
Tue-Wed 9/15-16	FOMC decision/SEP Wed 2p, presser 2:30p. Hike odds ~57% (CME FedWatch, this morning), down from a post-Jackson Hole peak near 66%.
AI IPO — [DEVELOPING]	Anthropic's IPO launch has slipped to "mid-October at earliest" (Reuters, 9/5); prospectus now expected late Sept., not this week; separately locked in a \$15B credit line (Forbes, 9/7) [timeline reported, not confirmed by the company]
AI infra — [NEW]	ByteDance secured a \$29.6B syndicated loan (~30 banks, led by Citi/JPMorgan) for AI-infrastructure buildout — Asia's 2nd-largest debt raise this year after SoftBank's \$40B in March [debt facility, not an equity VC round]

No verified rocket launch fell inside this run's window (SpaceX's next Starship flight targets 9/30, outside the 10-day window); sub-bullet skipped.

METRICS · AS OF ~6:15A ET WED 9/9 UNLESS NOTED

Brent / WTI	Brent \$99.1-99.3 (Globex, ~6:15a), through a 7-wk high near \$97-98.66 Tue no ICE settle located yet today ; WTI \$94.0-94.3, a 3-mo. high. Spread ~\$5.1
2Y / 10Y / 30Y	10Y 4.79%; 2Y 4.39%; 30Y 5.25% (Tue close)
DXY / VIX	DXY 98.85 (Tue, -0.33%); VIX 15.30 (Tue close, +2.75%)
S&P / Nasdaq futures	S&P +0.10%, Nasdaq-100 +0.22% (Wed premarket) — little changed
Dow / S&P / Nasdaq	52,786.07 (-628.18pts, -1.18%) / 7,673.52 (-0.58%) / 26,421.41 (-0.32%) — Tue close, oil + Canada trade war + inflation jitters
Asia & Europe	Nikkei ~65,090-65,240 (-0.04% to -0.27%, differing feeds) ; Kospi/HSI Wed close not located (HSI Tue -0.28%); Euro STOXX 50 +0.1% to 6,399; STOXX 600 flat 649.8; FTSE 100 +0.26%; DAX -0.12% (Tue)
Gold / retail gas	gold \$4,368-4,395/oz (Tue, -0.4% to -0.8% across feeds); gas \$4.1514/gal natl. avg (AAA, 9/8), essentially flat wk/wk
HORMUZ COUNTERS	
Closure	Day 192 since the Feb. 28 declaration (straits.live, as of 9/8)
Transits	6 vessels Aug. 30 vs. ~85/day baseline (straits.live, stale) — separately, Kpler counts ~10/day avg. over the past 10 days, lowest since May different vendor/window, not reconciled
Dark tankers	no share figure located this run ; UANI's Ghost Armada separately counts 41+ tankers anchored/loitering near the Eastern Pacific Oil Line — a different metric, not comparable
Strikes (24h)	Tue — CENTCOM destroyed 5 IRGC tankers (4 Gulf of Oman, 1 Kharg Island) after IRGC twice targeted a US warship in 2 days; overnight, Iran struck Jordan (see Calendar). Running total not maintained by this issue
War-risk premia	~\$10.0M per VLCC passage, ~40x pre-crisis (straits.live); unchanged order of magnitude

Kpler's near-real-time AIS counts, straits.live/PortWatch baseline snapshots, and UANI's anchored-tanker tracking measure different things over different windows — never netted or averaged against one another.

TRANSACTIONS

Yankees	beat the Rockies 5-3 Tue in Aaron Judge's return from a fractured rib (0-for-3, 2K); Schlittler K'd 10 over 7IP, Ramos added a 3-run 8th-inning HR. Now 82-61, 3.5 GB Tampa Bay (85-58); hold the top AL wild card
Knicks	Josh Hart extension still unsigned; latest reporting narrows the expected deal to 3-yr/\$60-62M (eligible for up to \$132M)
Northwestern	off this week after its 34-18 season-opening win (9/5); next game 9/19 vs. Colorado. No moves reported

LEAD

TANKER WAR AND BASE WAR CONVERGE

Iran hits a US-linked base in Jordan hours after CENTCOM destroys five more of its tankers — two episodes now read by markets as one continuous risk event

Overnight, the escalation cycle that has defined the Strait of Hormuz crisis since Saturday's naval clash took its sharpest turn yet inside about 36 hours. Tuesday, CENTCOM said it had destroyed five Iranian oil tankers — four in the Gulf of Oman (M/T Kaviz, Charminar, Horizon 1 and Riesco) and one near Kharg Island (M/T Derya) — after the IRGC twice targeted a US Navy warship with ballistic missiles over the prior two days; American forces reportedly ordered the tankers' crews to abandon ship before striking, and CENTCOM reported no US casualties. Then, in the early hours of Wednesday ET, Iran retaliated directly against a US-linked land target for the first time this week: the IRGC claimed ballistic missiles struck a hangar housing American RQ-4 and MQ-9 drones at Prince

Hassan Airbase in Jordan. Jordan's military said it intercepted 10 of 13 missiles fired, with the rest landing on open ground and no casualties reported, while a US official characterized the attack as "ineffective." **[single-sourced — ABC News, 3:02a ET — still developing, not yet corroborated by CENTCOM]**

The mechanism connecting the two episodes is now explicit and mutually reinforcing in a way it wasn't a week ago: US strikes destroy Iranian tankers, Iran retaliates against a US-linked land target in a third country rather than at sea, and markets treat both halves of the exchange as one continuous risk event rather than two separate incidents. That's a meaningful shift from last week's naval clash, where the retaliatory logic ran ship-to-ship. A strike on a Jordanian airbase pulls a US treaty-adjacent partner directly into the crossfire and raises the odds of an incident producing American or allied casualties — which would be a materially different market and political event than anything since the Feb. 28 closure declaration, given Jordan has otherwise stayed at arm's length from direct combat.

Brent has now traded through \$99 for the first time since the crisis began accelerating in late August, up from the high-\$80s three weeks ago; WTI sits at a three-month high near \$94. Tuesday's equity session already reflected the compounding pressure: the Dow's 628-point, 1.18% drop was its worst close in weeks, layering oil-driven inflation anxiety on top of Monday's trade-war escalation with Canada and a Fed decision now two weeks out. *With futures little changed early Wednesday (S&P +0.10%, Nasdaq-100 +0.22%), the market hasn't yet fully processed the overnight Jordan strike; whether Tuesday's selloff resumes at the open or the "ineffective" framing lets equities shrug it off is the first thing this reader should watch at 9:30.*

Two threads compound the picture. Qatar's Foreign Ministry warned Tuesday that continued disruption to the Strait risks an "industrial catastrophe" — a notable escalation in tone from a Gulf state that had largely avoided direct commentary on the crisis — as Kpler data put average daily transits over the past 10 days at their lowest since May. Separately, the new head of Iran's Supreme National Security Council, Mohsen Rezaei, said over the weekend that Tehran plans to formalize an "exclusion zone" outside the Strait, under which any vessel identified attempting to transit would be added to Iran's sanctions list. *No implementation date has been set, and the move would functionally codify what is already a near-total shutdown rather than materially change current transit volumes — but it would remove any ambiguity about Iran's claimed legal authority to interdict shipping beyond its own territorial waters.*

For the Fed, oil at \$99 complicates Friday's CPI regardless of what the print itself shows: a committee already split roughly down the middle on a September hike (CME FedWatch odds sit at 57% this morning, down from a post-Jackson Hole peak near 66%) now has to weigh a fresh energy-price impulse against President Trump's public campaign to push the Fed toward cuts ahead of the midterms — a tension this issue's Economics and Politics sections pick up below.

CENTCOM's own public framing of Tuesday's strikes is itself worth flagging: commanders have described the response doctrine in deliberately disproportionate terms since Saturday's clash — destroying multiple Iranian assets for every attempted Iranian strike on a US vessel — and the five-tanker response to two missile attempts fits that pattern exactly. *That doctrine is precisely what a Jordan-based retaliation is designed to route around: if the cost of hitting a US*

ship is a multiple of Iranian tankers, hitting a US-linked asset on Jordanian soil at least changes the venue, even if this particular attempt caused no reported damage. Whether Iran escalates again with a more effective strike, or whether Tuesday night proves to be the high-water mark of this cycle, is the single most consequential open question hanging over both the oil market and Friday's CPI reaction.

POLITICS

Trump's pressure campaign on the Fed has broadened past rhetoric: the president, vice president, Treasury Secretary Bessent and senior economic advisers are now publicly and repeatedly urging the Fed against a hike, and Trump has floated cutting off trade with unspecified countries unless the Fed lowers rates. The pressure lands two months before the midterms, with Republicans privately anxious that both chambers are at risk given voter dissatisfaction over prices and rates even though headline inflation (2.7% in July) sits far below 2026's post-tariff peak. Axios reported Tuesday that Trump's approach — running the midterm strategy through his own brand rather than down-ballot Republicans in swing races — is itself viewed by some in the party as a source of added risk. No new movement on the NBC data-center poll or the Missouri map ruling since last issue.

ECONOMICS

Fed funds remain at 3.50%-3.75%; a hike on Sept. 16 would take the range to 3.75%-4.00%. Governor Waller's own dividing line — a soft Friday CPI print — is now competing with an input August's jobs report didn't carry: oil near \$99 a barrel, which pushes toward the hawkish side of the ledger independent of Friday's data.

Consensus for Friday's headline print (2.9% y/y, up from 2.7% in July) already implies some upward drift before oil's latest leg is even reflected in the data; one dissenting forecast (Ameriprise's Russell Price) sees a hotter 0.4% m/m print on tariff and food-cost pass-through. Waller's own words from his Sept. 3 speech are the clearest statement of his threshold: policy, he said, "is currently only slightly restricting aggregate demand, and it may not take much acceleration in inflation to nudge me into supporting tighter policy" — a framing that leaves him little room if Friday surprises to the upside. Thursday brings weekly claims (prior wk: 206k) alongside Adobe and Oracle earnings — a data-and-earnings pileup two days before the Fed's decision.

BUSINESS

Adobe's abrupt Sept. 4 CEO-succession announcement — Anil Chakravarthy to succeed Shantanu Narayen as CEO effective Dec. 1, with Narayen moving to executive chair and creativity-unit head David Wadhwani departing — knocked the stock down 6.5% and now overhangs Thursday's earnings, where consensus already left little room for a beat even before the leadership overhang. Oracle reports the same day; consensus calls for \$1.74 EPS on \$19.14B revenue. Nvidia's Hugging Face acquisition (see 9/7 issue) continues to draw regulatory attention specifically on vertical-foreclosure concerns given Hugging Face's scale — more than 18M developers, 3M-plus models; Nvidia's public commitment is to keep the platform hardware-agnostic, multi-cloud and multi-accelerator, which is the specific commitment regulators reviewing the deal through mid-2027 will be testing against Nvidia's actual behavior post-close. No new movement on the Amazon FTC ad-auction suit since last issue; the underlying numbers remain a \$20B alleged overcharge across

1.2M advertisers against Amazon's counter-claim of an \$8B advertiser saving from 2021-2025.

TECHNOLOGY

ByteDance's \$29.6B syndicated loan (see Board) is being read by lenders as a confidence signal on the company's creditworthiness — the facility is unsecured and priced at 68bp over SOFR, an improvement on the 85bp it paid on 2024 offshore debt — and lands as the second-largest Asian debt raise of the year after SoftBank's \$40B OpenAI-linked facility in March. GPT-6 Astra's rollout is unchanged since last issue: live for Pro/Enterprise/Business-Premium in Work and Codex, Plus/Business rollout still completing, no ChatGPT Free access confirmed. Anthropic's IPO timeline has slipped to mid-October at the earliest per Reuters, with the prospectus now expected late September rather than this week; the company separately locked in a \$15B credit line.

GEOPOLITICS

Ukraine's Prosecutor General Ruslan Kravchenko resigned Sept. 7 amid a corruption scandal, a political story running alongside the military one: Ukraine's General Staff reported 205 combat clashes and 52 Russian air strikes (186 guided bombs) in a single day this week, and a brief drone alert sounded over Kyiv. Two Russian Su-35 fighters reportedly collided over Kursk Oblast Sept. 7, per Russian Telegram channels **[single-sourced]**. Russia's military has again pushed back its internal deadline for capturing the Donbas, according to Ukrainian officials. The brief cross-border strike pause tied to last week's US shuttle diplomacy expired Sept. 7 with no extension announced; no confirmed resumption of long-range strikes against Moscow or Kyiv located this run.

IRAN & HORMUZ

Iran's planned Hormuz "exclusion zone," first flagged by Supreme National Security Council chief Mohsen Rezaei over the weekend, would run "from the line of the US naval blockade, extend toward the Strait of Hormuz, and continue into the Persian Gulf" — any vessel identified attempting to transit would be added to Iran's sanctions list, per Rezaei's comments to Iran's state broadcaster. No formal announcement or start date has followed as of this run. Qatar's Foreign Ministry spokesperson Majed Al-Ansari said opening the Strait is now a global priority, warning of an "industrial catastrophe" if disruption continues — a notable escalation in tone from a Gulf state that has largely avoided direct commentary on the crisis until now (see Lead). Transit and dark-tanker figures are covered in the Board above; note only that Kpler's ~10/day 10-day average and

straits.live's single-day Aug. 30 count of 6 measure different things — a rolling average vs. a spot count — and shouldn't be read as confirming or contradicting one another. Separately, UANI's tanker tracking says it has not observed a single Iranian-crude-laden tanker successfully depart the Gulf of Oman and evade US enforcement since July 12, when the current blockade posture was reinstated — a data point about outbound flow that is distinct from, and shouldn't be conflated with, the Board's inbound transit counts.

SPORTS

Yankees	W 5-3 over Rockies Tue, Judge's return from the IL. Now 82-61, 3.5 GB Tampa Bay (85-58); hold the top AL wild card
Knicks	Hart extension still unsigned; latest reporting points to a 3-yr/\$60-62M deal
Northwestern	1-0, off this week; next game 9/19 vs. Colorado

Continuity. Dropped as resolved/unchanged since 9/7: Saturday's naval-clash mechanics (superseded by Tuesday's tanker strikes and the overnight Jordan attack); the NBC AI-data-center poll and Missouri map ruling. Watching: whether CENTCOM corroborates or disputes Jordan's 10-of-13 intercept count; today's cash-equity open; Thursday's Adobe/Oracle earnings and jobless claims; Friday's CPI; Iran's formal exclusion-zone announcement; Anthropic's delayed IPO prospectus.

Unverified figures are marked in red. Nothing was estimated or filled from memory.